

Experiment 2 – Qualys User Creation and Role Configuration

AIM

To create a user in the Qualys platform and configure an appropriate role, application access, asset scope and permissions so that the account has controlled access to the required security functions.

REQUIREMENTS

- Qualys Cloud Platform account
- Authorized Manager/User Administrator access for user management
- Web browser with internet connectivity
- VM/VMDR access, where required by the practical
- Required user information such as name and email address

DETAILED STEPS

1. Log in to the Qualys Cloud Platform using an authorized administrative account.
2. Open the Administration module and navigate to the user-management area.
3. Choose the option to create a new user and open the user-creation form.
4. Enter the mandatory general information, including first name, last name, title, phone number, email address, address and country as required by the account.
5. Open the Locale section and select the required language, date format and time zone.
6. Open User Role and select the required predefined role. Qualys roles determine which actions a user can perform.
7. Configure GUI/API access where the subscription and practical require it.
8. Assign the appropriate business unit or leave the account unassigned according to the lab requirement.
9. Assign asset groups when required. Asset groups determine which assets, domains or scanner appliances the user can access for scanning and reporting.
10. Open the Permissions section and enable only the permissions required for the practical.
11. Review notification/options settings if they are required for the account.
12. Review the Security section and configure available security controls such as two-factor authentication or SSO according to the organization's configuration.
13. Review all fields carefully and save the user account.
14. Return to the Users/User Management list and locate the newly created account.
15. Open the user details and verify the selected role, permissions, business-unit scope and asset groups.
16. Record the account status. A newly created user may initially be shown as Pending Activation and can become Active after the user completes the activation process.

ROLE AND PERMISSION CONCEPT

A Qualys user is associated with a predefined role such as Manager, Unit Manager, Scanner or Reader. The role controls the actions available to the account. Certain extended permissions can be enabled or cleared individually, depending on the role and subscription configuration.

OBSERVATION

The account was configured using role-based access control. The selected role defines the basic access level, while additional permissions and asset/business-unit scope further restrict what the user can perform and access.

CONCLUSION

User creation and role configuration demonstrate controlled access to Qualys resources. Applying only the permissions needed for the user's task follows the principle of least privilege and reduces unnecessary administrative access.